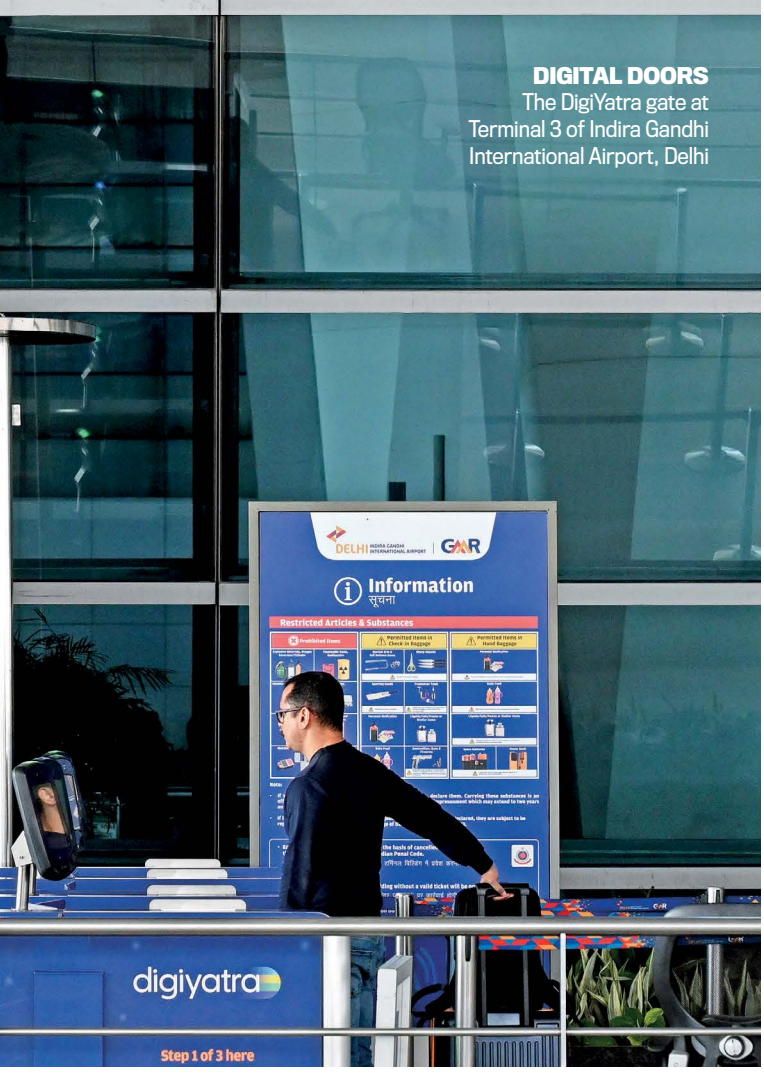


DIGITAL DOORS
The DigiYatra gate at Terminal 3 of Indira Gandhi International Airport, Delhi

ARUN KUMAR

Passengers head directly to the DigiYatra gate, where facial recognition technology verifies their identity in seconds, granting instant access

to the airport, they use DigiYatra for smooth travel."

The app's success is reflected in its rapid adoption. With over 9.2 million active users, 25,000 daily downloads and 49 million journeys facilitated to date, DigiYatra has transported users to the next level of air travel. Initially launched at the Delhi, Bengaluru and Varanasi airports, 24 locations now boast of the facility.

However, the journey may have just begun. "Currently available only in English, DigiYatra will support all 22 official languages by March," says Suresh Khadakbhavi, CEO of the Digital Yatra Foundation, the non-profit spearheading the initiative.

While concerns about biometric data security occasionally arise, both the foundation and government policy assure users that all data is stored locally and automatically deleted within 24 hours of departure. Looking to the future, the foundation is setting its sights beyond national borders. "We're excited about the prospects of enabling DigiYatra for seamless international travel," Khadakbhavi adds. ■

HOW IT TRANSFORMED MY LIFE

"It's an unbelievable use of technology"

Ashu Gandhi has travelled to many countries and experienced countless airports throughout his long airline career. Yet, he says, it is in India that he has discovered the most seamless way to handle airport check-ins: through DigiYatra.

"I was flying from Bengaluru to Delhi a few days ago," he recalls. "Midway to the airport, I realised I'd forgotten my laptop bag with all my documents—driver's licence, Aadhaar, PAN—at home. All I had was my mobile phone. If this were before, I'd have missed the flight." Luckily, Gandhi had recently uploaded his documents to DigiLocker at his wife's insistence. "That saved me," he says. As his taxi sped toward the airport, Gandhi retrieved his IDs, downloaded the DigiYatra app, registered and uploaded his boarding pass. "At the airport, I didn't need to show anything at the entrance," he explains. "With the DigiYatra app open, the gate scanned my face from a distance, and the gates opened. I didn't even need to hold my phone up."



ASHU GANDHI, 59
Retired airline manager, Delhi

In minutes, Gandhi was through security and at his boarding gate, with time to spare. "It's an unbelievable use of technology," he says, praising how the app has transformed the travel experience. For Gandhi, DigiYatra turned what could have been a travel nightmare into a smooth, stress-free journey. ■